



二、语篇分析及试题精解

I ① The U. S. Postal Service (USPS) continues to bleed red ink. ② It reported a net loss of \$ 5. 6 billion for fiscal^① 2016, the 10th straight^② year its expenses have exceeded revenue^③. ③ Meanwhile, it has more than \$ 120 billion in unfunded liabilities, mostly for employee health and retirement costs. ④ There are many reasons this formerly stable federal institution finds itself at the brink of bankruptcy^④. ⑤ Fundamentally, the USPS is in a historic squeeze^⑤ between technological change that has permanently decreased demand for its bread-and-butter product, first-class mail, and a regulatory^⑥ structure that denies management the flexibility to adjust its operations to the new reality.

美国邮政(USPS)继续处于严重赤字状态。它公布了2016财年高达56亿美元的净亏损额,这是连续第10年其支出超过收入。同时,它还背负着超过1200亿美元的无资金准备债务,主要是员工医疗和退休金。这个昔日稳固的联邦机构之所以发现自己处于破产边缘,原因有多种。根本原因在于,USPS正身陷“历史性挤压”:一面是技术变革导致对其核心产品(普通邮件)的需求永久性降低;一面是监管体系使得其管理层无法灵活调整业务以适应新现实。

· 词汇注释与难句分析 ·



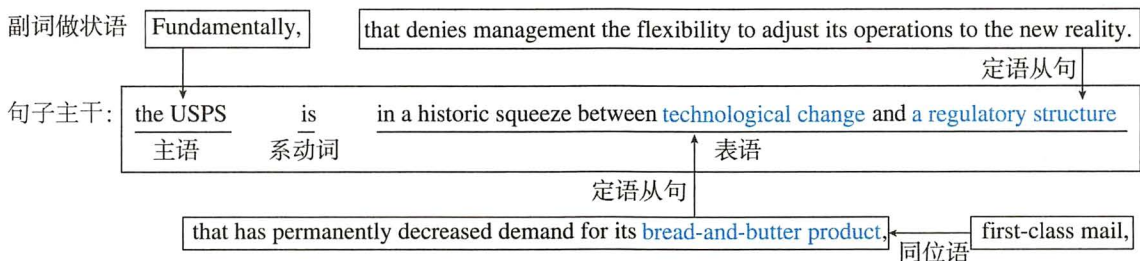
- ① fiscal[ˈfɪskl]a. 财政的
② straight[streɪt]a. 一个接一个的,不间断的
③ revenue[ˈrevənjuː]n. (公司、组织或政府的)收入
④ bankruptcy[ˈbæŋkrʌptsi]n. 破产
⑤ squeeze[skwɪz]n. 挤压,拮据,紧缩
⑥ regulatory[ˈregjʊlətɔːri]a. 监管的,管理的

● 经典搭配

- ① at the brink of 在……边缘
② bread-and-butter product 基本产品、主要产品
③ deny sb sth 拒绝某人做某事,使某人无法完成某事

Fundamentally, the USPS is in a historic squeeze between technological change that has permanently decreased demand for its bread-and-butter product, first-class mail, and a regulatory structure that denies management the flexibility to adjust its operations to the new reality.

结构切分:



功能注释: 本句骨架为 the USPS is in a historic squeeze between... and...。technological change 和 a regulatory structure 为将 USPS 左右夹击(squeeze)的力量;二者都带有定语从句 that..., 说明两个因素对 USPS 的负面影响。

· 语篇分析 ·



第一、二段为第一部分,提出问题情形:USPS 长期严重亏空,立法改革屡屡受阻。

第一段指出 USPS 面临境况(长期严重亏空、目前处于破产边缘),并明确根本原因。关键词:① at the brink of bankruptcy; ② in a historic squeeze。